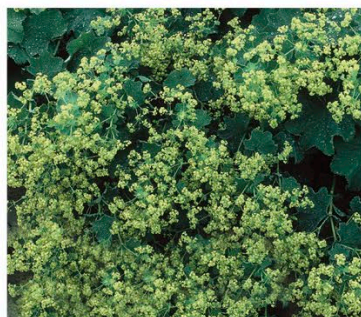




Plants for weed-suppressing ground cover

Spreading plants that cover the soil with mats of weed-proof stems and leaves can convert a labor-intensive garden into an easy-care, relaxing space.

Although these plants are tough, most have specific site requirements so check that your garden conditions suit your choices. Choose stonecrops and heathers for sunny areas and lady's mantle, gingers, and ferns for gloomy spots. As well as spreading leafy stems, many ground-cover plants also have beautiful flowers—a succession of wall rock cress and bunchberry followed by hardy geraniums and roses will provide months of colorful blooms. However, these vigorous plants may spread beyond their boundaries if not kept in check, so trim occasionally to prevent them from swamping more delicate specimens.



PERENNIAL SMALL

Alchemilla mollis

LADY'S MANTLE This perennial forms a mound of rounded pale green leaves that suppress surrounding annual weeds. In summer, it produces lax branching sprays of small lime-green blooms. Best planted in shade, it is ideal for the front of a bed.

±20in (50cm)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z4–7



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Amsonia tabernaemontana

WILLOW BLUE-STAR This upright perennial forms a dense mound of weed-suppressing growth. It has blue star-shaped spring flowers and bold fall foliage. Plant it in groups or alongside other ground-cover plants for the best effect.

±3ft (1m) ↔ 12in (30cm)

☀️ ☀️ ⚠️ Z3–9 (N)



PERENNIAL LARGE

Anemone x hybrida

JAPANESE ANEMONE With its branching stems and white and pink flat-faced flowers that last into fall, this large perennial is ideal for late summer color. It has a spreading habit and forms a low canopy of foliage in summer.

±5ft (1.5m) ↔ indefinite

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z4–8



PERENNIAL SMALL

Ajuga reptans

BUGLEWEED This spreading evergreen perennial forms close-knit rosettes of glossy dark green leaves. Small blue flower spikes appear in late spring and early summer. 'Atropurpurea' (above) has bronze-tinted leaves. Considered invasive in some areas.

±6in (15cm) ↔ 3ft (1m)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z3–9



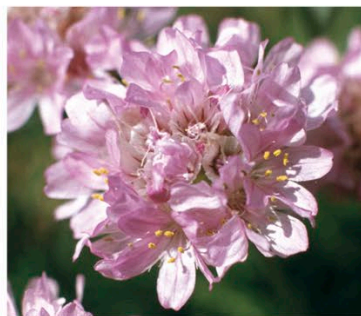
PERENNIAL SMALL

Arabis alpina subsp. *caucasica*

WALL ROCK CRESS This mat-forming evergreen perennial has hairy gray-green leaves and small white flowers from early spring to early summer. Plant it in groups at the front of a bed or in a rock garden.

±6in (15cm)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z4–7



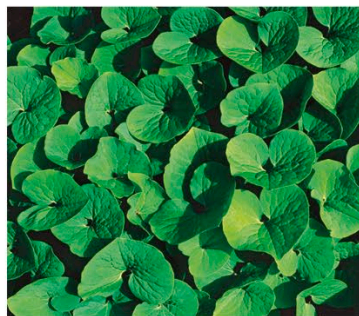
PERENNIAL SMALL

Armeria maritima

THRIFT A clump-forming evergreen perennial with grassy mounds of slender green leaves. In summer, it bears rounded heads of small, white or pink papery blooms. Plant it at the front of a free-draining bed and allow it to naturalize.

±4in (10cm) ↔ 6in (15cm)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z4–8 (N)



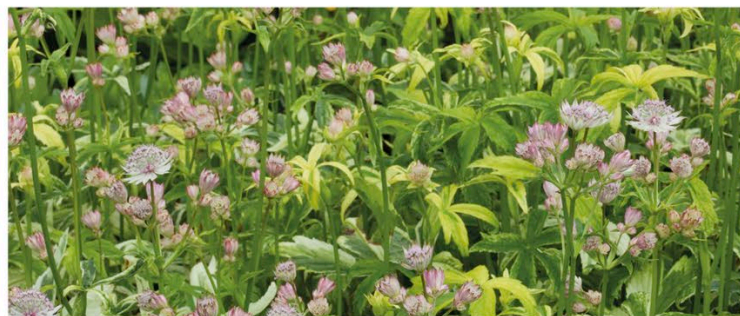
PERENNIAL SMALL

Asarum canadense

WILD GINGER This ground-cover perennial produces rounded kidney-shaped ornamental leaves that form a green carpet. Small cup-shaped purple-brown flowers appear in summer, but are hidden. Plants are tolerant of deep shade.

±6in (15cm) ↔ 12in (30cm)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z3–7 (N)



PERENNIAL MEDIUM

Astrantia major

MASTERWORT An upright clump-forming perennial with divided green leaves and, from midsummer to early fall, sprays of small greenish white, pink, or red flowers. 'Sunningdale Variegated' (above) has cream-accented leaves.

±3ft (1m) ↔ 18in (45cm)

☀️ ☀️ ☀️ Z4–7